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Global Macro Commentary | Global

October 23: Fueling Up for CPI

5% rally in Brent oil; US President Trump to meet with Chinese President Xi on October 30; potential UK tax hikes; Turkey CBT cuts 100bp; Korea BoK on hold & leans hawkish; more details of Korea's US investment deal; US signals action in Venezuela; DXY at 98.936 (+0.0%); US 10y at 4.001 (+5.2bp).

Risk sentiment strengthens despite elevated geopolitical tensions, with a sharp rally in oil prices driving moves across rates and currency markets.

Developed Markets

- US rates sell off ~5bp across the curve as constructive US-China trade signals boost risk sentiment ahead of Friday's September CPI release.** Treasury yields rise throughout the New York session as equities strengthen (S&P 500: +0.6%), supported by the US administration [confirming](#) that President Trump will meet with Chinese President Xi on October 30 ahead of the APEC Summit. Energy stocks lead the rally (S&P Energy: +1.3%) as Brent oil prices climb another 5% to roughly \$66 in the wake of Wednesday's US sanctions proposals on Russian oil companies. The oil-sensitive NOK outperforms the G10 (USD/NOK: -0.5%) while the dollar trades sideways (DXY: +0.0%).
- Inflation expectations rise alongside oil prices, but are seemingly kept in check by lingering growth and data concerns.** Despite the sharp rally in oil prices, 1y CPI swaps increase by only 1-2bp. Likewise, the afternoon's 5y TIPS auction tails by 1.2bp on tepid demand, and breakeven rates widen only ~1bp across the curve. The move is potentially constrained by [data quality concerns](#) amid the government shutdown, with our inflation strategists [noting](#) outflows from TIPS in recent weeks. Based on state-level data, our economists estimate that new jobless claims rose 232k in the week of October 18, down from 220k the week before but roughly in line with the average pace over the last two months (235k in September; 231k in August). These results imply no further pickup in layoffs, though we estimate continuing claims rose slightly to 1.941mn from the prior week's 1.928mn.
- European rates sell off ~2bp across the curve in sympathy with US Treasuries, while long-end UK gilts outperform (30y: -1bp) amid dovish statements from BoE external member Dhingra and [reports](#) of potential tax hikes,** which could ease some fiscal concerns ahead of the November Budget. After European markets close, local media [reports](#) that Chancellor Reeves is considering raising the income tax — one of the measures [noted](#) by our UK economists as likely to be supportive of the bond market, though politically unpopular. GBP underperforms (GBP/USD: -0.2%) in line with yield differentials. Meanwhile, the OAT-Bund spread widens another 0.7bp ahead

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of Moody's rating of France expected Friday.

- **Long-end Japanese rates rally (30y: -4bp) as fiscal concerns around the new administration moderate, in line with our economists' [expectations](#).**

Demand for long tenors is supported by a smaller-than-expected 15.5-39y auction, which sees its size reduced by JPY100bn. The long end strengthens in the Tokyo afternoon on the back of the strong auction, and should remain well-supported given the light supply calendar ahead. With the front end selling off slightly (JGB 5y: +0.5bp), the curve ultimately twist flattens. JPY lags G10 peers, ending the New York session 0.4% weaker against USD as oil prices and Treasury yields rise. The move is supported by retreating expectations for a BoJ hike in October and geopolitical uncertainty, with Prime Minister Takaichi scheduled to meet with US President Trump on Tuesday.

Emerging Markets

- **In Turkey, front-end rates sell off (1y: +10bp) after the CBT delivers a 100bp cut, in line with consensus but smaller than the 150bp cut [expected by our economists](#).** TRY weakens slightly (EUR/TRY: +0.1%) but remains range-bound ahead of a [court ruling](#) expected Friday with potential implications for domestic politics. Czech rates also sell off in a bear-steepening (2y: +1bp; 10y: +3bp). In South Africa, ZAR strengthens 0.5% against USD as gold rebounds from its recent [sell-off](#).
- **Asian currencies and rates mostly underperform on the back of JPY weakness and higher oil prices, with Korea leading declines as the BoK holds rates steady.** Despite the decision aligning with expectations, markets seemingly view the results as hawkish because the BoK's guidance shows one less member being open to a rate cut than expected. As a result, Korean rates bear-steepen (2y KRW NDIRS: +4bp). Our economists continue to [expect](#) a cut in November, but remove a cut penciled in for 2Q26 and adjust their terminal rate forecast to 2.25%. KRW leads regional FX underperformance (USD/KRW: +0.6%), weakening alongside rising oil prices and JPY. Local media [reports](#) that the \$350bn US investment could comprise \$25bn annual investments over eight years, with the other \$150bn being credit guarantees, though President Lee [suggests](#) the negotiations may not be complete by the APEC Summit.
- **Commodity prices drive currency strength in India and Thailand.** In India's first trading session since Monday, INR appreciates 0.1% and 10y IGBs sell off 3bp on the back of the oil rally and Wednesday's [reports](#) of a potential trade deal. In Thailand, THB gains 0.2% alongside the rebound in gold prices while THB NDIRS yields remain stable. CNH is a regional outperformer, holding steady around 7.1240 per USD, supported by a new low in USD/CNY fixing (7.0918; P: 7.0954).
- **LatAm currencies outperform, with Colombia leading gains against the**

dollar (USD/COP: -0.7%) due to its sensitivity to oil prices. The move is supported by Colombian officials detailing [plans](#) to proceed with buybacks for global bonds with high coupons. Colombia's IBR curve bear-steepens mildly, with most regional curves selling off alongside US Treasuries. Meanwhile, Venezuela's external bonds rally (VENZ 2027: +0.8 cash points) as President Trump [signals](#) potential US military action on Venezuelan land.

Central Bank Monitor

Developed Markets

- **BoE External Member Dhingra** [said](#) that tariffs put downward pressure on global prices in the medium term by weakening growth and demand.

Emerging Markets

- In Korea, the **BoK** maintained its policy rate at 2.50%, in line with expectations. MPC member Shin voted for a 25bp cut. The central bank [stated](#) that "it is necessary to further monitor financial stability conditions, such as the effects of real estate market stabilization measures on housing markets in Seoul and its surrounding areas and on household debt, as well as exchange rate volatility." The BoK sees growth and inflation generally consistent with its August forecasts but noted both upside and downside risks to growth. **BoK Governor Rhee** [said](#) that while the easing bias remains intact given Korea's negative output gap, the scale and timing of potential cuts have been adjusted. He revealed that four members are open to a rate cut in the next three months, down from five at the August meeting, adding that it is too early to say if a cut is possible in November. [Read more](#)
- In Turkey, the **CBT** lowered its policy rate by 100bp to 39.5% from 40.5%. The pace of easing was slower than the 150bp cut expected by our economists. The CBT's statement highlighted more pronounced risks to the disinflationary process. [Read more](#)
- In Taiwan, **CBC Governor Yang** [told](#) lawmakers that Taiwan's trade surplus with the US is projected to reach around \$120bn in 2025. He noted the central bank is paying close attention to avoid being accused of currency manipulation as tariff negotiations are underway. He said the CBC aims to maintain stability in TWD to ensure smooth operations and stable pricing for businesses and avoid crossing the US Treasury's red line. In his view, it is difficult to say if a Fed rate cut would place upward pressure on TWD. He signaled openness to working with FSC to launch FX hedging products, and added that the CBC has not bought gold this year but may consider more purchases if FX reserves are sufficient.

Exhibit 1: G4 Rates Closes (5pm NY)

Tenor	US			Germany			UK			Japan		
	23-Oct	1d Δ (bp)	2wk	23-Oct	1d Δ (bp)	2wk	23-Oct	1d Δ (bp)	2wk	23-Oct	1d Δ (bp)	2wk
2y	3.489	4.4		1.924	1.7		3.774	1.1		0.930	1.1	
3y	3.494	5.0		1.974	1.7		3.763	2.1		1.009	1.0	
5y	3.609	5.6		2.179	2.1		3.885	1.5		1.222	1.5	
7y	3.787	5.6		2.319	2.0		4.023	0.7		1.442	2.0	
10y	4.001	5.2		2.582	2.0		4.423	0.6		1.663	2.4	
20y	4.554	4.9		3.063	1.9		5.102	0.4		2.617	(0.7)	
30y	4.579	4.8		3.167	2.1		5.228	0.7		3.080	(2.2)	

Source: Morgan Stanley Research, Bloomberg

Exhibit 2: Inflation Closes (5pm NY)

US TIPS				10y Real Yields, BEI							
Tenor	23-Oct	1d Δ (bp)	2wk	10y	23-Oct	1d Δ (bp)	2wk	10y	23-Oct	1d Δ (bp)	2wk
5y	1.226	5.0		DBRi	0.619	0.2		BTPi	1.684	1.7	
BEI	3.180	82.7		BEI	1.755	1.8		BEI	1.713	0.8	
10y	1.696	3.7		UKTi	1.518	0.6					
BEI	2.303	1.4		BEI	2.975	(0.1)					
30y	2.355	3.5		JGBi	0.046	(0.8)					
RFI	2.225	1.3		RFI	1.590	3.0					

Source: Morgan Stanley Research, Bloomberg

Exhibit 3: Macro Closes (5pm NY)

Spot	Majors			Spot	EM			Index	Equities / Commodities		
	23-Oct	1d Δ (%)	2wk		23-Oct	1d Δ (%)	2wk		23-Oct	1d Δ (%)	2wk
DX	98.94	0.0		CNH	7.13	0.0		S&P	6738.44	0.6	
EUR	1.162	0.1		INR	87.85	(0.1)		Stoxx	5668.33	0.5	
GBP	1.333	(0.2)		THB	--	--		FTSE	9578.57	0.7	
JPY	152.57	0.4		KRW	1437.40	0.4		Nikkei	48641.61	(1.4)	
CHF	0.795	(0.1)		ZAR	17.33	(0.5)		VIX	17.30	(7.0)	
AUD	0.651	0.4		MXN	18.40	(0.2)		Gold (S)	4126.28	0.7	
CAD	1.399	(0.0)		BRL	5.38	(0.3)		WTI (Fut)	61.79	5.6	

Source: Morgan Stanley Research, Bloomberg

Exhibit 4: G4 Central Bank Implied Pricing

Fed	Central Bank OIS				BOE	Central Bank OIS				BOJ	Central Bank OIS			
	Implied	1d Δ (bp)	Total Δ	ECB		Implied	1d Δ (bp)	Total Δ	SONIA (10/22)		Implied	1d Δ (bp)	Total Δ	TONAR (10/22)
EFFR (10/22)	4.110	0.0		EDONIA (10/22)	1.927	0.0			3.969	0.0				0.477
10/29/25	3.858	(0.5)	(25.2)	10/30/25	1.926	0.4	(0.1)		11/06/25	3.885	0.7	(8.4)		0.477
12/10/25	3.624	0.9	(48.6)	12/18/25	1.897	1.1	(2.0)		12/18/25	3.793	0.3	(17.6)		0.660
01/28/26	3.493	3.0	(61.7)	02/05/26	1.871	0.6	(5.6)		02/05/26	3.642	(0.1)	(32.7)		0.690
03/18/26	3.370	4.2	(74.0)	03/19/26	1.826	2.3	(10.1)		03/19/26	3.580	(0.1)	(38.9)		0.5
04/29/26	3.303	5.5	(80.7)	04/30/26	1.808	(0.6)	(11.9)		04/30/26	3.473	(0.3)	(49.6)		21.3
06/17/26	3.167	6.1	(94.3)	06/11/26	1.774	(0.3)	(15.3)		06/18/26	3.435	(0.3)	(53.3)		

Source: Morgan Stanley Research, Bloomberg

The Day Ahead*Developed Markets*

- 7:00am BST - **UK September Retail Sales ex Auto Fuel** (MSe: -0.2% m/m; C: -0.7%; P: 0.8%). We expect a slight correction, with our forecast based on the BRC survey.
- 8:30am EST - **US September CPI** (MSe: 0.41% m/m; C: 0.4%; P: 0.4%). We expect core CPI to rise 0.32% m/m in September (3.12% y/y), with a fourth straight month of positive core goods inflation. Core services likely decelerated, driven by softer shelter and airfare components, partly offset by firmer medical services. Headline CPI is expected to increase 0.41% m/m and 3.10% y/y. [Read more](#)
- 9:45am EST - **US October S&P Global US Manufacturing PMI** (C: 52; P: 52). The S&P manufacturing index, which provides nationwide coverage, has been trending higher since last September and remains near its highest levels

since 2022 despite a dip in September. We closely track the output prices index, which peaked at 64.5 in June and eased to 56.5 in September, aligning with softer core goods CPI.

- 10:00am EST - **US October UMich Consumer Sentiment** (C: 54.5; P: 55). In the preliminary October release, 5–10 year inflation expectations held steady at 3.7%—below the April peak of 4.4%, but still above the 2024 average (3.0%) and pre-COVID levels (2.5%). Consumer sentiment remained subdued at 55.0, with the expectations index still well below last year's level.

Emerging Markets

- Fri 1:00pm HKT - **India Preliminary October HSBC Manufacturing PMI** (P: 57.7); **Services PMI** (P: 60.9) and **Composite PMI** (P: 61.0)
- 1:00pm HKT - **Singapore September Industrial Production** (C: 0.5% y/y; P: -7.8%)
- 8:00am EST - **Brazil October IPCA** (Mse: 0.25% m/m; P: 0.48; C: 0.24%). The print is expected to be driven by lower electricity tariffs. Food inflation may partially offset the decline due to seasonal acceleration. A softer print would reinforce the BCB's cautious stance and support the case for holding rates steady. The market is currently pricing in ~1.7bps of cuts for the remainder of 2025, and ~260bps of cuts from 2026-2027, with a terminal rate of ~12.31 in April 2027.

Economic Releases

Developed Markets

- **US September Existing Home Sales:** 4.1m (MSe: 4.06m; C: 4.1m; P: 4m). Existing home sales rose 1.5% to a 4.06 million annual rate, matching our forecast and leaving our 3.5% 3Q GDP tracking unchanged. Inventories are gradually rising, easing price growth to 2.3% y/y from 4.4% a year ago.
- **US October Kansas City Fed Manufacturing Activity:** 6.0 (C: 2; P: 4). The index rose for the fourth straight month in October, with the composite index climbing to 6 from 4. While most components showed modest gains, expectations for future activity accelerated, signaling cautious optimism despite lingering weakness in production and employment.
- **Canada August Retail Sales:** 1.0% m/m (C: 1.0%; P: -0.8%); **Retail Sales ex-Auto:** 0.7% m/m (C: 1.3%; P: -1.2%). The largest increases were in motor vehicle and parts dealers, led by new car dealers. Core retail sales showed broad-based strength, while building materials were weak. Purchases of new autos and other goods suggest consumers continued spending in August despite ongoing trade tensions.
- 7:45pm BST - France October Business Confidence (MS: 96; C: 96; P: 96)
- 3:00pm BST - EA October Consumer Confidence (MS: -14.6; C: -15; P: -14.9)

Emerging Markets

- **Singapore September Headline CPI:** 0.7% y/y (C: 0.6%; P: 0.5%); **Core CPI:** 0.4% y/y (C: 0.2%; P: 0.3%)
- **Taiwan September Industrial Production:** 15.5% y/y (C: 14.5%; P: 13.7%)

- **Hong Kong September Composite CPI:** 1.1% y/y (C: 1.1%; P: 1.1%)
- **Philippines Budget Balance:** -PHP248.1bn (P: -PHP84.8bn)
- **Poland September Unemployment Rate:** 5.6% (C: 5.6%; P: 5.5%)
- **Mexico IH October CPI 2H/1H:** 0.28% (Mse: 0.34%; P: 0.02%; C: 0.38%).

Inflation came in below consensus and our economists' [expectations](#), reinforcing the view that price pressures remain contained. Core inflation printed at 0.18%, broadly in line with seasonal norms, with non-food goods and processed food prices staying below historical averages, likely reflecting peso strength and weak domestic demand. Core services were firmer, driven by housing and tourist services, while restaurant-related categories remained sticky. Non-core components ex-energy contributed to the disinflationary trend. The print supports Banxico's easing bias, with markets pricing in ~41bps of cuts for the remainder of 2025 and ~32bps for 2026, implying a terminal rate near 6.77% in March. Our economists [expect](#) 25bp cuts in both November and December, ending 2025 at 7.00% and reaching 6.50% by March 2026.

- **Mexico August Retail Sales:** 2.4% (P: 2.40% y/y; C: 2.60%) The print came in unchanged from the prior month and slightly below consensus expectations. The data continues to reflect subdued domestic demand, consistent with recent weakness in broader activity indicators.

For more details, please refer to our economists' weekly reports and data previews:

- [US](#)
- [Japan](#)
- [Europe](#)
- [Asia/Pacific](#)
- [LatAm](#)
- [CEEMEA](#)

Please [click here](#) if you would like to receive our weekly strategic advice on global rates, FX, and EM. See our latest [Global Macro Strategist: Missing the Global Disinflation Forest for the US Inflation Tree](#) and recent publications:

- ECB Preview: [Last Postcard from the Good Place](#)
- Netherlands Economics, Rates Strategy & Banks: [Parliamentary Election Preview - Robust Outlook Amidst a \(Likely\) Long Government Formation Process](#)
- Cause and FX: [Live from New York, It's Currency Insight](#)

G4 Smarter (Beta) Trading Partners

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Since 2000, enhancements to a G4 10y government bond futures momentum strategy have produced higher Sharpe ratios and stronger returns relative to total return government bond indices for the G4: US, Germany, Japan, and the UK. See [A "Smarter" \(Beta\) Way to Trade G4 10y Futures Duration?](#) for more information on these strategies.

Exhibit 5: Trading Signals for G4 Smarter (beta) Trading Strategy

Current Risk, G4 10y Futures	G4 Strategy Weight	Trade Longs Portfolio	Fade Shorts Portfolio	Total Risk Trade Longs Only	Total Risk Trade Longs/Fade Shorts (max 200%)	Trade Longs Portfolio Entry Date	Trade Longs Portfolio Exit Date	Fade Shorts Portfolio Entry Date	Fade Shorts Portfolio Exit Date
J8 10y Future	32.50%	100%	100%	100%	200%	10/15/2025	11/20/2025	9/19/2025	10/28/2025
GE 10y Future	29.25%	100%	0%	100%	100%	10/7/2025	11/11/2025	-	-
US 10y Future	30.50%	100%	100%	100%	200%	10/14/2025	11/19/2025	9/24/2025	10/30/2025
UK 10y Future	7.75%	100%	100%	100%	200%	10/15/2025	11/19/2025	9/25/2025	10/30/2025

Source: Morgan Stanley Research

Trading Strategy 1 – "Trade Longs/Fade Shorts"

When the 5-day moving average crosses above the 20-day moving average, buy the futures contract (long duration) and hold for a 25-business-day period. When the 5-day moving average crosses below the 20-day moving average, buy the futures contract and hold for a 25-business-day period. In short, this strategy buys futures when the Simple Moving Average Crossover (SMAX) generates both a long and a short signal, given the historical outperformance of long signals traded long and the underperformance of short signals traded short. Given that the SMAX could generate both a long and a short signal within the predefined holding period, an investor may have a 200% long position since each of the two signals would be traded in separate portfolio sleeves.

Trading Strategy 2 – Trade "Longs Only"

When the 5-day moving average crosses above the 20-day moving average, buy the futures contract (long duration) and hold for a 25-business-day period. When the 5-day moving average crosses below the 20-day moving average, do nothing. In short, an investor *only* trades long signals initiated by the SMAX given their historical precedent to outperform.

US Holiday Trading Strategy

Currently Active Strategies

None.

Combining the individual trading signals based on 10y Treasury future (TY) price patterns before and after US holidays has generated an annual strategy with no down years since 1987. See [Trading 10y Treasury Futures Around US Holidays](#) for more information.

Using historical data since 1983, we created a trading strategy using 10y Treasury futures (TY) that trades 11 times per year, either long or short, before or after the following US holidays: New Year's Day, Martin Luther King Day, Presidents' Day, Good Friday, Memorial Day, Independence Day, Labor Day, Columbus Day, Thanksgiving, and Christmas. [Exhibit 6](#) displays the trading rules:

Exhibit 6: Trading rules for US holiday trading model using US 10y futures contracts (TY)

Holiday	Day of Week	Direction	Before/After Holiday	Trading Rule (business days, 3pm NY unless specified)	Trade Entry (business days)	Trade Exit (business days)
New Year's Day	Rotates	Long TY	After	Buy TY New Years +1, Sell TY New Years +4	New Year + 1	New Year + 4
Martin Luther King Day 1	Monday	Long TY	Before	Buy TY Tuesday before MLK, Sell Friday before MLK	MLK - 4	MLK - 1
Martin Luther King Day 2	Monday	Short TY	After	Sell TY Tuesday after MLK, Buy Friday after MLK	MLK + 1	MLK + 4
President's Day	Monday	Long TY	After	Buy TY Tuesday after Pres. Day, Sell TY Friday after Pres. Day	Pres. Day + 1	Pres. Day + 4
Good Friday	Friday	Long TY	After	Buy TY Monday after Good Friday, Sell TY Friday after Good Friday	Good Friday + 1	Good Friday + 5
Memorial Day	Monday	Long TY	After	Buy TY Tuesday after Mem. Day, Sell TY Friday after Mem. Day	Mem. Day + 1	Mem. Day + 4
Independence Day (July 4th)	Rotates	Long TY	After	Buy TY Independence Day + 2, Sell TY Independence Day + 4	Ind. Day + 2	Ind. Day + 4
Labor Day	Monday	Long TY	Before	Buy TY Monday before Labor Day, Sell TY Thursday before Labor Day	Labor Day - 4	Labor Day - 2
Columbus Day	Monday	Short TY	Before	Sell TY Monday before Col. Day, Buy TY Thursday before Col. Day	Colum. Day - 5	Colum. Day - 2
Thanksgiving	Thursday	Long TY	Before	Buy TY Friday before Thanksgiving, Sell TY Tuesday before Thanksgiving	Thanksgiving - 4	Thanksgiving - 2
Christmas	Rotates	Short TY	Before	Sell TY Christmas Day - 4, Buy TY Christmas Day - 1	Christmas - 4	Christmas - 1

Source: Morgan Stanley Research. Note: Past performance is no guarantee of future results.

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Stock Rating Category	Coverage Universe		Investment Banking Clients (IBC)			Other Material Investment Services Clients (MISC)	
	Count	% of Total	Count	% of Total IBC	% of Rating Category	Count	% of Total Other MISC
Overweight/Buy	1499	41%	389	46%	26%	702	41%
Equal-weight/Hold	1618	44%	375	44%	23%	782	45%
Not-Rated/Hold	4	0%	1	0%	25%	1	0%
Underweight/Sell	577	16%	88	10%	15%	234	14%
Total	3,698		853			1719	

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